

IAS PRELIMS 2020

STATE BY STATE



ASSAM

DEMOGRAPHICAL

GEOGRAPHICAL

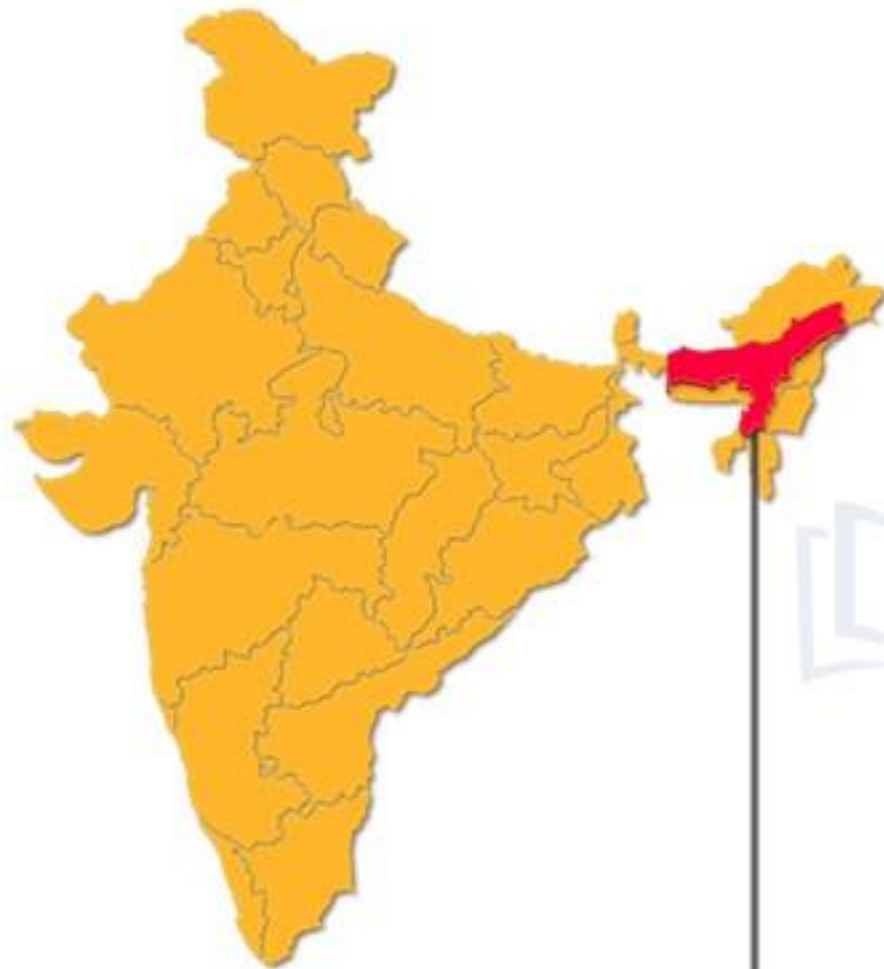
ENVIRONMENTAL

CULTURAL

MODULE - 7

1

HIGHS AND LOWS

**ASSAM**

1

Article 371B –
Provides special
status. (Also part of
Schedule VI)

2

Highest GDP among
North-eastern states.

3

Largest producer of
tea in India –
Contributes to 50%
tea production.

4

Bhupen Hazarika
Setu (Dhola-Sadiya
bridge across Lohit
River) - India's
longest River bridge.

5

Largest producer
(31.73%) of
Onshore natural
gas in India.

6

Digboi is the Asia's
oldest and World's
2nd oldest oil field

7

Majuli is the largest
river island in the
world.

8

Umananda is the
smallest river island
in the world.

STATE BY STATE ... ASSAM

2

BOUNDARIES



- Shares border with 7 states
- Assam and Chhattisgarh stand at 2nd place in sharing border with maximum states (UP shares border with 8 states and Delhi UT).
- Assam shares border with Bhutan and Bangladesh.

- STATE BOUNDARY
- INTERNATIONAL BOUNDARY



- Contains three of six physiographic divisions of India
 - ✓ The Northern Himalayas (Eastern Hills),
 - ✓ The Northern Plains (Brahmaputra plain) and
 - ✓ Deccan Plateau (Karbi Anglong).
- Karbi Anglong is an extension of the Indian Plate (The Peninsular Block) in the Northeast India.
- Falls under Seismic Zone V

STATE BY STATE ... ASSAM

3

RELIEF FEATURES



- Structure of Assam is divided into three units:
 - ✓ Karbi Plateau (Innermost part of Meghalaya Plateau)
 - ✓ Tertiary depositional zone (North Cachar Hills and Barail Range)
 - ✓ Plains of Brahmaputra and Barak Valley



B H U T A N

ARUNACHAL PRADESH

WEST BENGAL

Mikir Hills

Karbi Hills

Rengma Hills

North Cachar
Hills

South Brahmaputra Hills

MEGHALAYA

NAGALAND

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

MANIPUR

Barak Plain

Barail Range

- **Mikir Hills:** Located to the south of the Kaziranga National Park. Part of the Karbi Anglong Plateau.
- **Cachar hills and Barail range:** separate the Brahmaputra Plain from Barak Valley.



B H U T A N

Lohit

Subansiri

Brahmaputra

Dihing

Dhanisi

Kameng

Manas

Beki

Brahmaputra

Brahmaputra

MEGHALAYA

Barak

MANIPUR

H

- **Subansiri:** Joins Brahmaputra in Upper Assam Valley.
- **Dihing or Burhi Dihing:** Originates in the the Patkai Hills in Arunachal Pradesh.
- **Barak:** originating in the Barail Range (Assam-Nagaland border), flows through the Cachar plain and enters Bangladesh with the name Surma River.

- **Brahmaputra:** forms major part of Assam landscape, flowing across the length of the entire state.

STATE BY STATE ... ASSAM

4

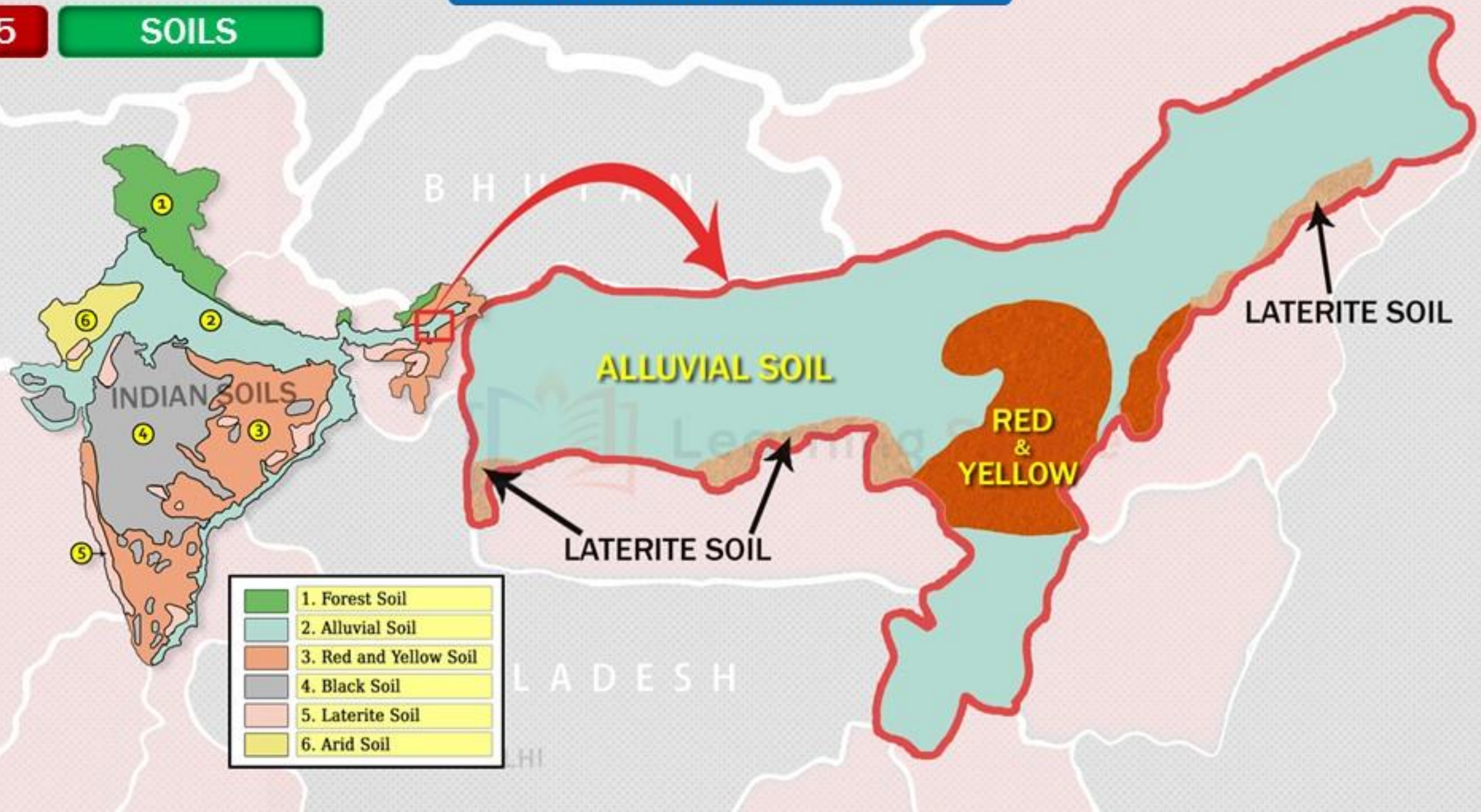
DRAINAGE SYSTEM - DAMS



STATE BY STATE ... ASSAM

5

SOILS



STATE BY STATE ... ASSAM



- **Climate:** Tropical Monsoon Rainfall type with heavy rainfall and humidity.
- Meghalaya Plateau results in Orographic rainfall in the Southern margin.

STATE BY STATE ... ASSAM

7

MAJOR CROPS



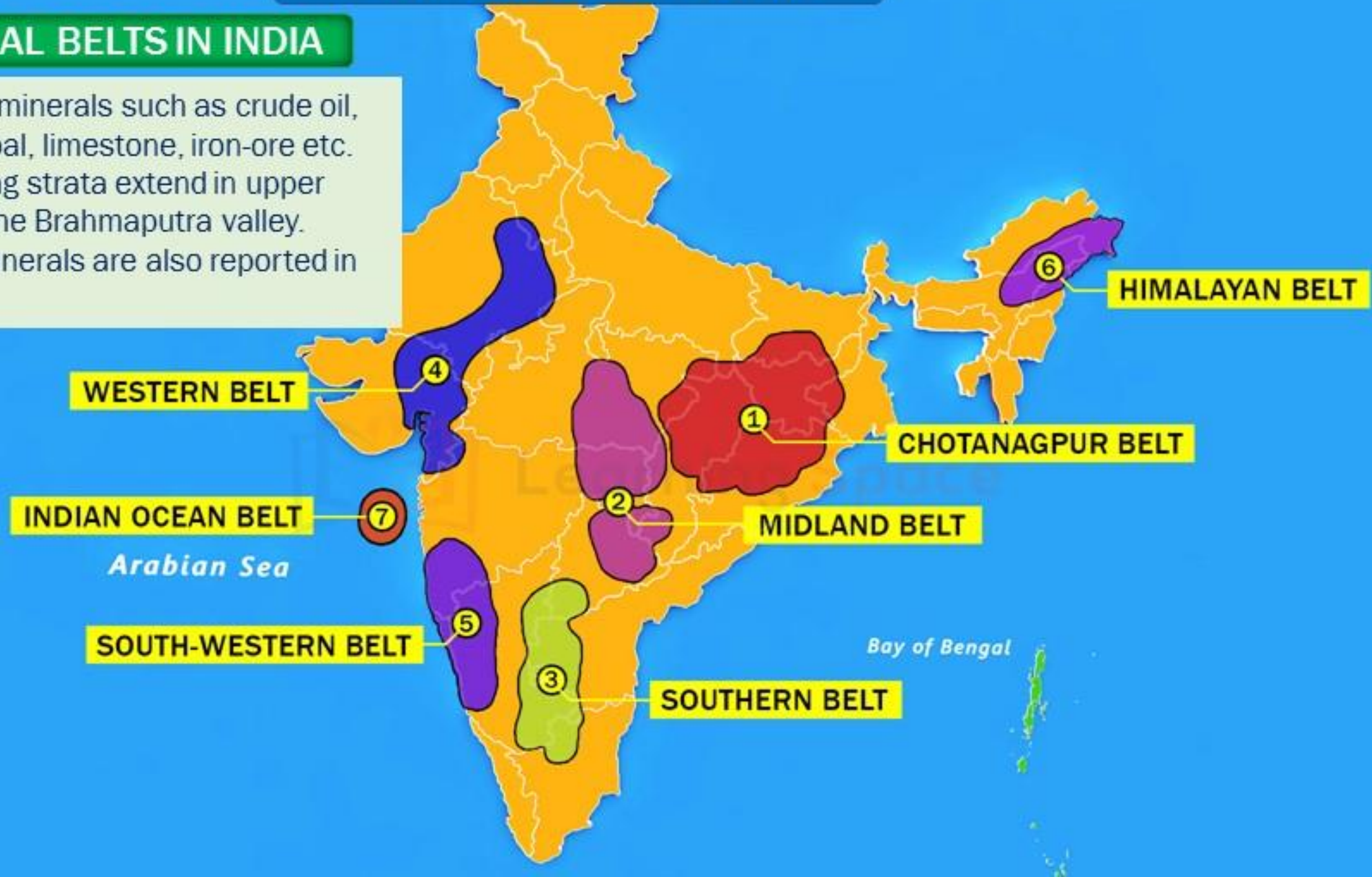
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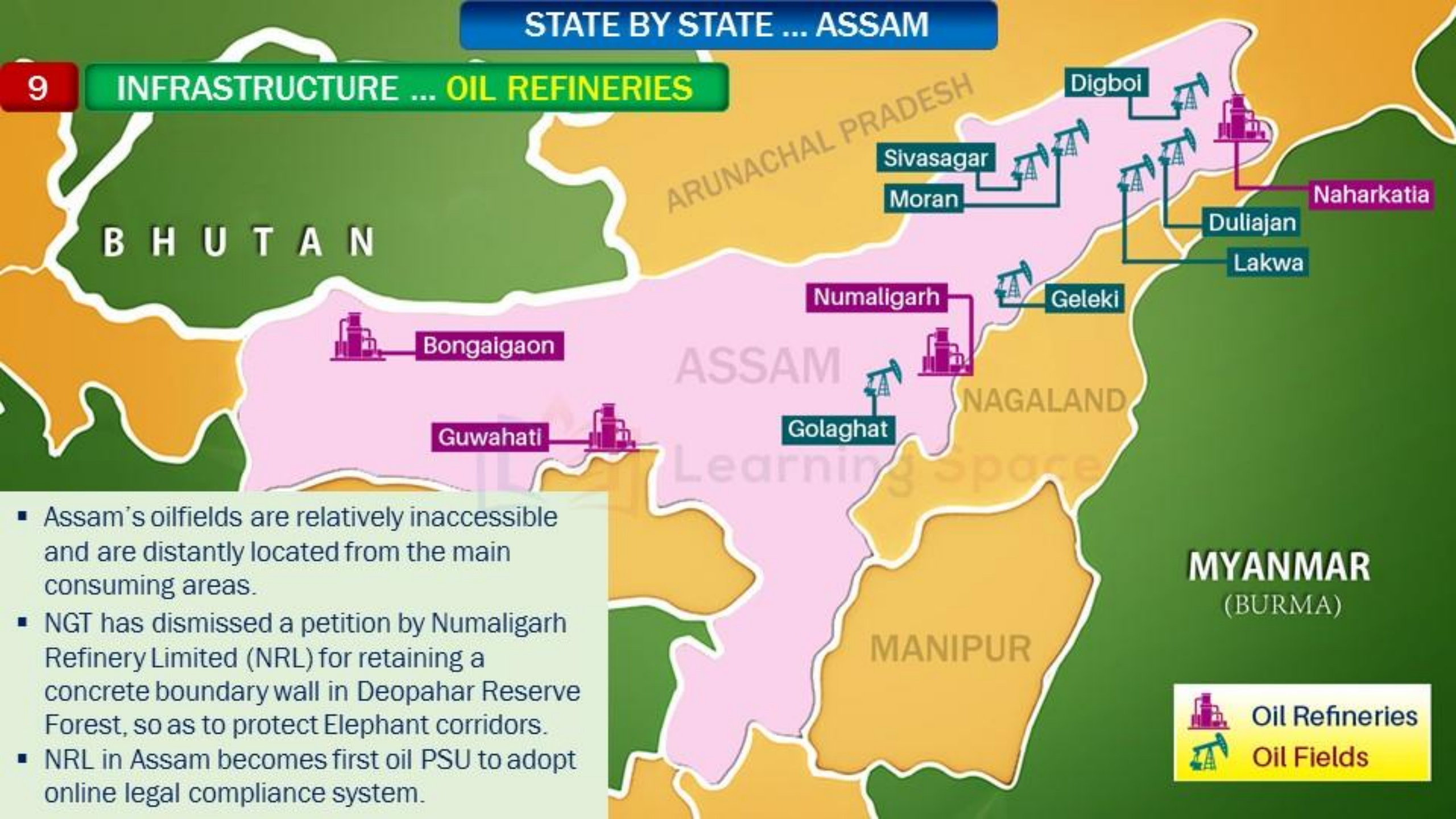
	Rice		Potato
	Sugarcane		Tea
	Wheat		Oil Seeds
	Arecanut		Jute

- Tea is the most important cash crop in Assam and the state is well known world-wide for its tea.

8 MINERAL BELTS IN INDIA

- Endowed with minerals such as crude oil, natural gas, coal, limestone, iron-ore etc.
- Main oil bearing strata extend in upper Assam along the Brahmaputra valley.
- Radioactive minerals are also reported in Assam.





- Assam's oilfields are relatively inaccessible and are distantly located from the main consuming areas.
- NGT has dismissed a petition by Numaligarh Refinery Limited (NRL) for retaining a concrete boundary wall in Deopahar Reserve Forest, so as to protect Elephant corridors.
- NRL in Assam becomes first oil PSU to adopt online legal compliance system.



- **Kopili HPS:** Suffered serious damage due to contamination of Kopili river with acid mine discharge from open cast coal mines and rat hole mining in Meghalaya.



B H U T A N

WEST BENGAL

Brahmaputra

Saraighat

Kolia Bhomora Setu

Kameng

Dhanisi

Subansiri

Bogibeel

Dholasadiya

Lohit-Digaru

Lohit

MYANMAR

MEGHALAYA

Bogibeel Bridge:

- Referred to as “Lifeline of Assam”.
- Asia’s second-longest railroad bridge.
- Plays an important role in defence by facilitating ease of mobility to the India-China border in Arunachal Pradesh.
- Three road lanes of the bridge can act as three landing strips for the Air Force.

- **Dholasadiya Bridge:** Longest bridge in India over water (on Lohit River).
- **Dibang River Bridge (Arunachal Pradesh):** 2nd longest bridge above water in India



NW 2

SADIYA

DHUBRI

ASSAM

BRAHMAPUTRA

MEGHALAYA

MANIPUR

NAGALAND

BANGLADESH

TRIPURA

MIZORAM

MYANMAR
(BURMA)CHINA
(TIBET)ARUNACHAL
PRADESH

BHUTAN

SIKKIM

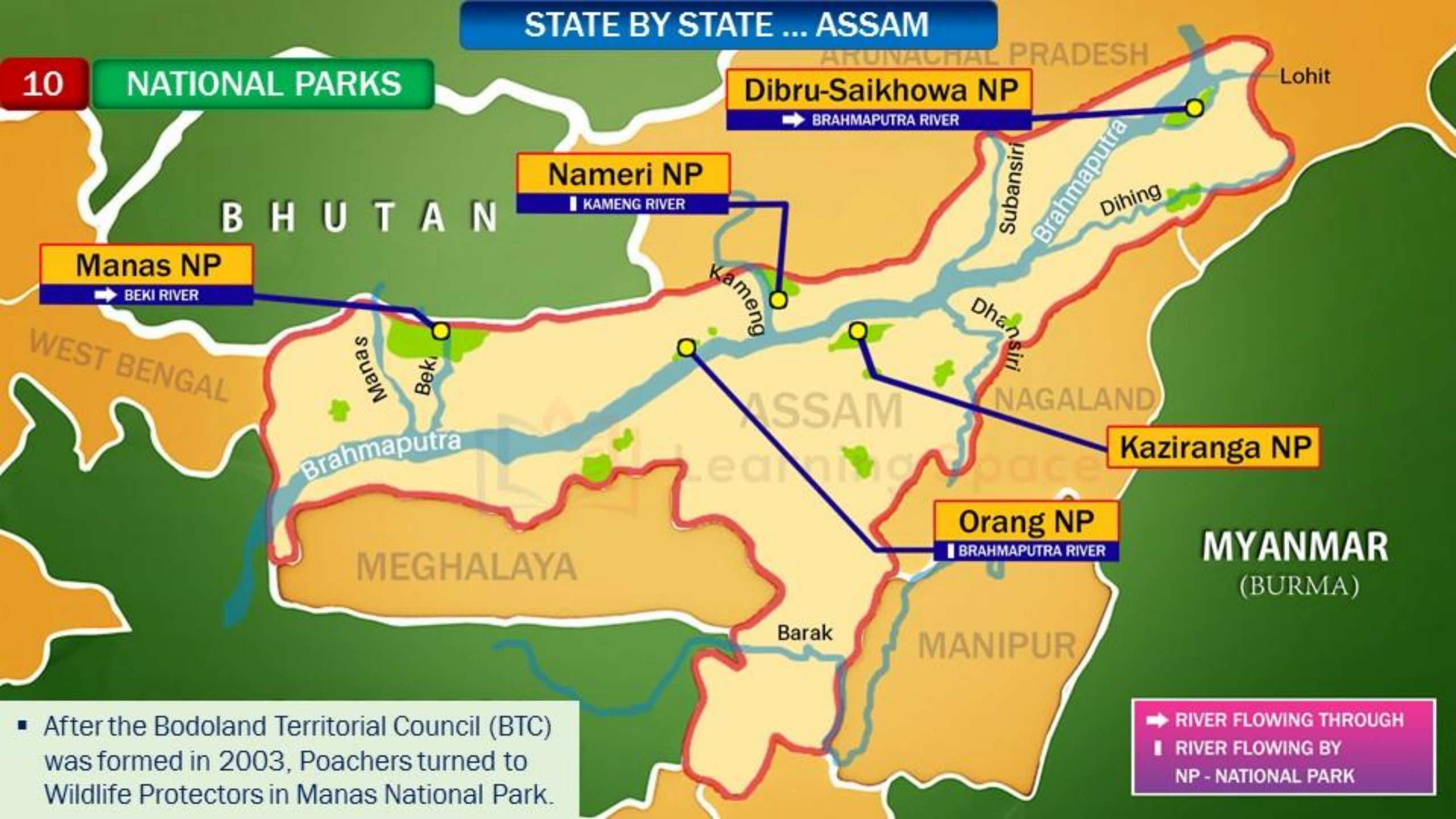
NEPAL

- First-ever container cargo movement on Brahmaputra (NW-2) will sail via NW-1 (River Ganga), Indo-Bangladesh Protocol (IBP) route and National Waterway-2 (River Brahmaputra).

STATE BY STATE ... ASSAM

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NATIONAL PARKS



Manas NP

→ BEKI RIVER

Nameri NP

↓ KAMENG RIVER

Dibru-Saikhowa NP

→ BRAHMAPUTRA RIVER

Kaziranga NP

Orang NP

↓ BRAHMAPUTRA RIVER

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

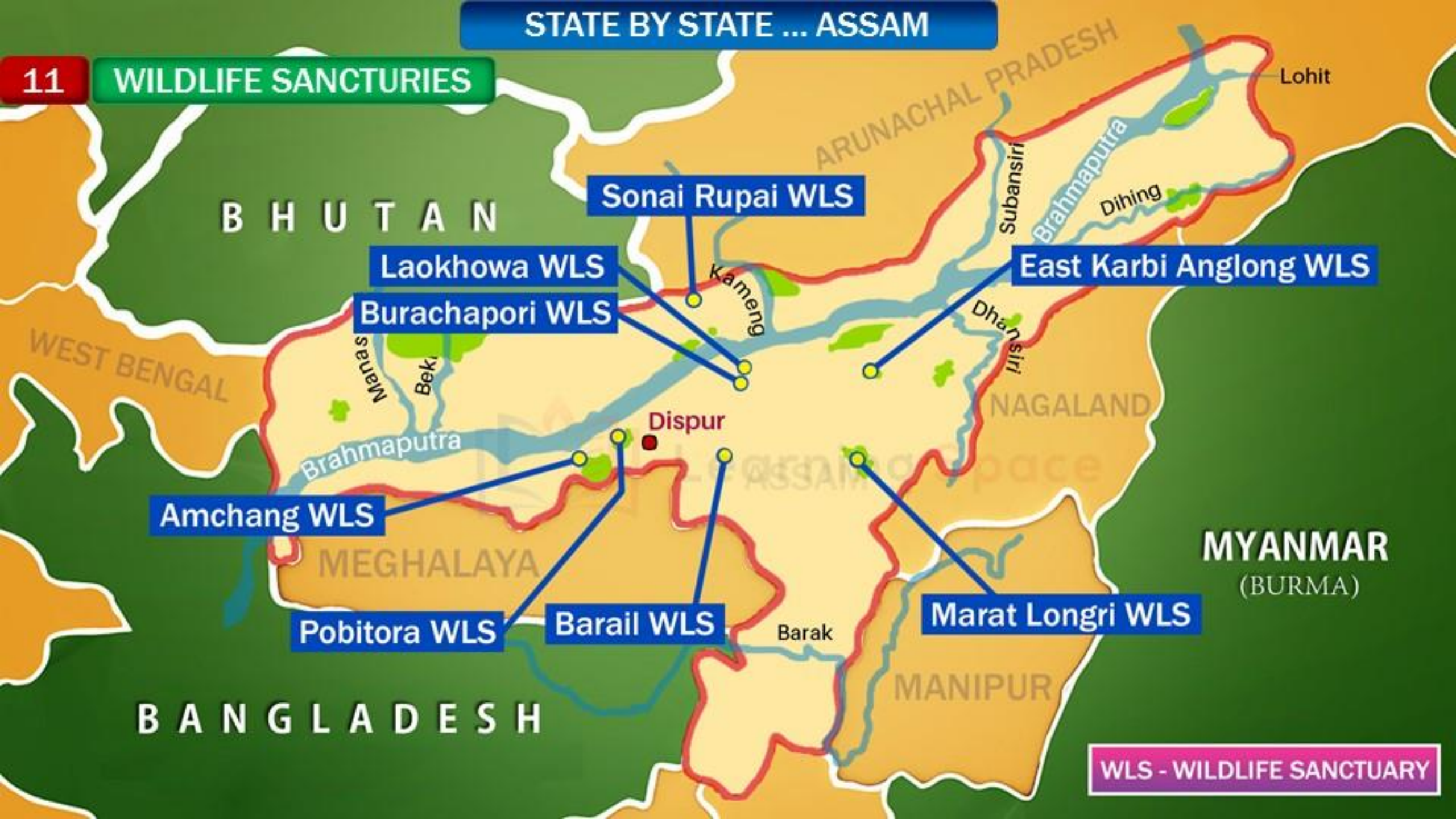
→ RIVER FLOWING THROUGH
↓ RIVER FLOWING BY
NP - NATIONAL PARK

- After the Bodoland Territorial Council (BTC) was formed in 2003, Poachers turned to Wildlife Protectors in Manas National Park.

STATE BY STATE ... ASSAM

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WILDLIFE SANCTUARIES





Manas BR

Dibru-Saikhowa BR

Deepor Beel RW

Dispur

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

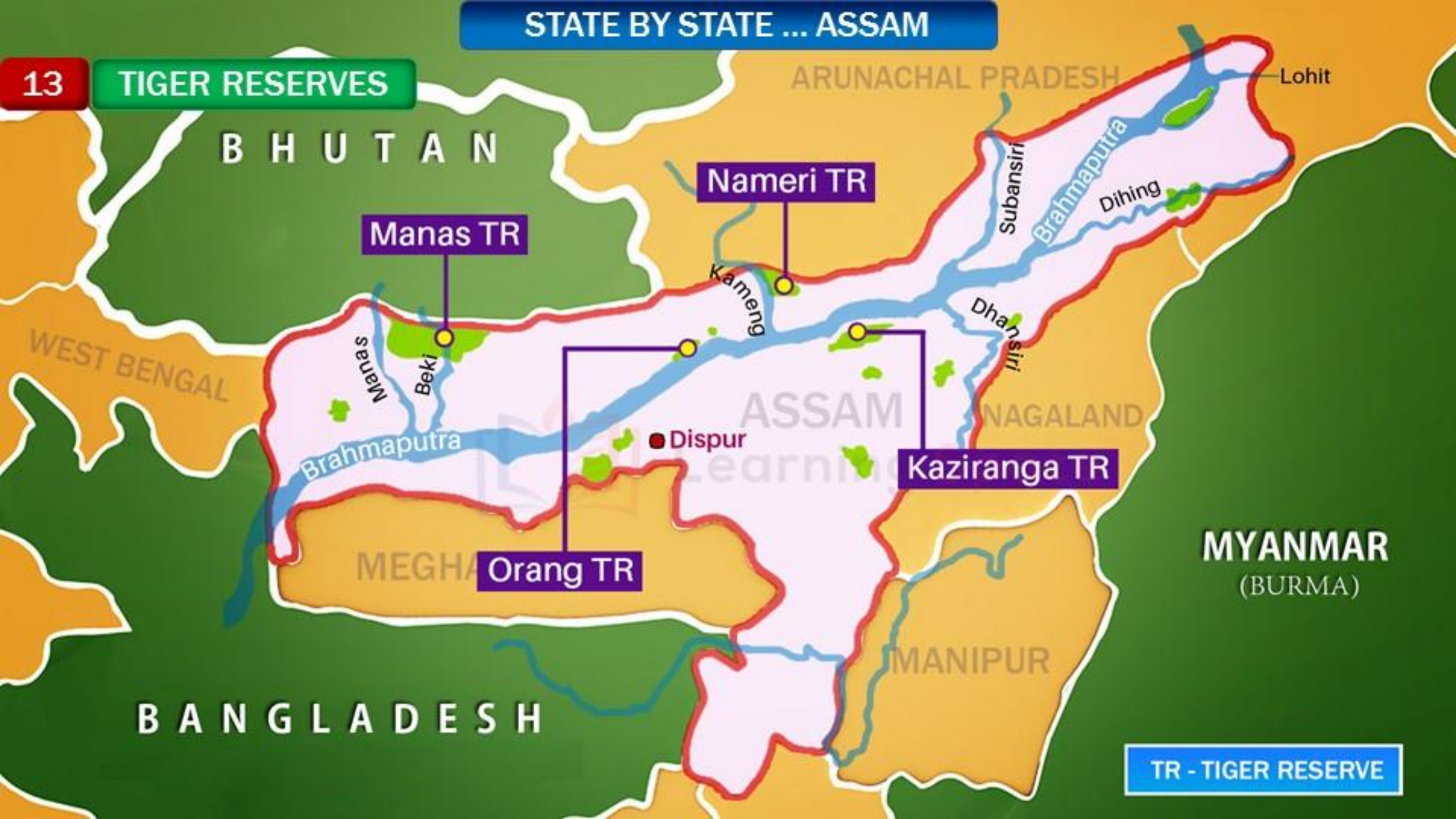
■ Biosphere Reserve
■ Ramsar Wetland

- **Deepor Beel:** It is a permanent freshwater lake to the south of the Brahmaputra river.
- **Manas BR:** Houses Manas National Park and Manas Tiger Reserve.

STATE BY STATE ... ASSAM

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TIGER RESERVES



BHUTAN

ARUNACHAL PRADESH

Lohit

Nameri TR

Manas TR

Subansiri

Dihing

Dhanisi

WEST BENGAL

Manas

Beki

Kameng

Dispur

NAGALAND

Kaziranga TR

MEGHALAYA

Orang TR

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

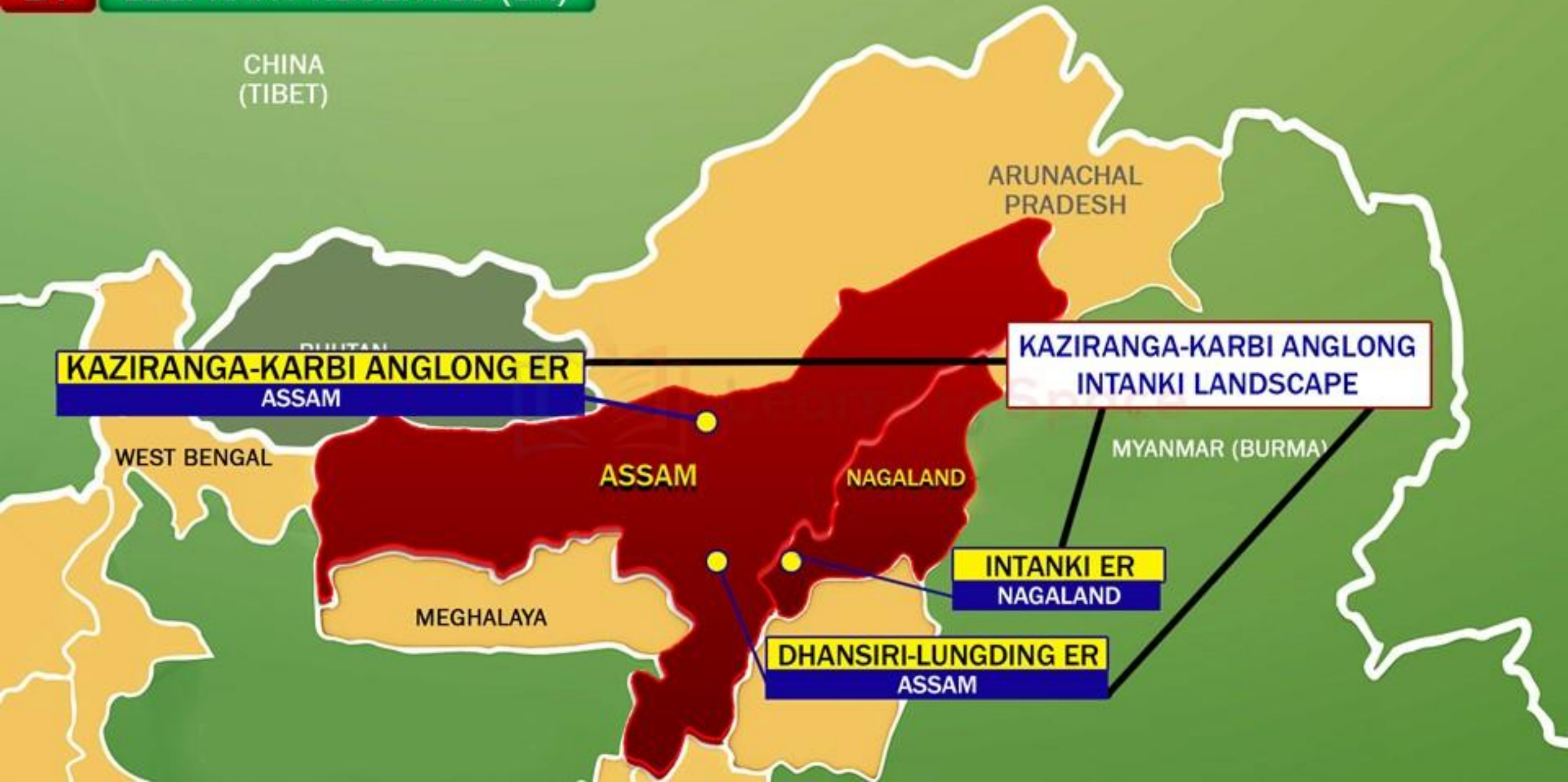
MANIPUR

BANGLADESH

TR - TIGER RESERVE









STATE BY STATE ... ASSAM

15

UNESCO - WHS

B H U T A N

Manas Wildlife Sanctuary

ARUNACHAL PRADESH

Lohit

Subansiri

Dihing

Dhanisi

Kameng

Dispur

Kaziranga National Park

NAGALAND

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

WEST BENGAL

MEGHALAYA

Barak

MANIPUR

B A N G L A D E S H



AMBUBACHI MELA



- Also known as Ameti or Tantric fertility festival.
- It is a three day fair held during June/July at the Kamakhya temple in Guwahati.
- Large number of pilgrims gather to celebrate the yearly menstruation course of goddess Kamakhya.

RANGALI BIHU FESTIVAL



- Marks the traditional New Year in the local calendar.
- Main aspect of the festival is the Bihu dance and the traditional Husori songs performed by youngsters accompanied by music troupes with indigenous musical instruments such as Pepa, Gogona, Taal, Dhol and Hutuli.

RAAS FESTIVAL



- Raas Festival showcases Bhaona, or traditional dance dramas that depict tales from Hindu mythology.
- Part of Neo-Vaishnav culture of Vaishnavite sect of Hinduism which was started by the medieval saint Srimanta Sankardev.

MAGH BIHU FESTIVAL



- Also called as Bhogali Bihu as it is celebrated with community feasts after the annual harvest.
- Festival also marks Makar Sankranti

BOHUWA DANCE



- The Sonowal Kacharis performs the Bohua dance in praise of Lord Shiva.
- Signifies the beginning of a new life, a clean society and the riddance of bad omen.

OJAPALI DANCE



Oja (lead dancer) narrates a mythological story along with the fusion of dance and acting.

- It is of three types -
 - ✓ biyah-gowa that presents Mahabharata stories with the rhythmic use of feet,
 - ✓ sukananni which celebrate the worship of snake goddess Manasa, and
 - ✓ ramayani is based on the Assamese version of Ramayana.

Schedule VI of the Constitution deals with the administration of Tribal areas in Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram. For Assam, the Tribal areas are:

- ✓ The North Cachar Hills District
- ✓ The Karbi Anglong District
- ✓ The Bodoland Territorial Areas District

AHOM PEOPLE

- Found in Assam and Arunachal Pradesh.
- Categorized in other backward classes (OBC) caste category.
- There is a demand for the Schedule Tribe for a long time.

BODO PEOPLE

- Part of greater Bodo-Kachari family.
- Speak Bodo language, recognized as one of 22 scheduled languages in Indian Constitution.
- Recognized as a plains tribe in Schedule VI.

BARMAN KACHARIS

- Indigenous Assamese community and are a subsection of the Dimasa people.
- Classified as Scheduled Tribe (Plains) in the valley of Barak.
- Celebrates the indigenous traditional Bihu festival.

GOLDEN LANGUR



- **Golden Langur Conservation Project:** undertaken at the Assam State Zoo in Guwahati during 2011-12
- Funded by the Central Zoo Authority
- An isolated and undisturbed site within the zoo was chosen to provide a natural habitat for the primates with a golden coat endemic to Assam
- Apart from north-western Assam, small populations are found in Bhutan and Tripura.
- IUCN Status: Endangered

INDIAN RHINO



- MoEFCC has undertaken a project to create DNA Profiles of all Rhinos present in India.
- Database will be hosted in Wildlife Institute of India (WII), headquarters in Dehradun.
- More than 90% of Indian Rhino population is concentrated in Kaziranga National Park.
- Indian Rhino Vision 2020 (Launched in 2005): An ambitious effort to attain at least 3,000 greater one-horned rhinos in Assam by 2020.

WILD WATER BUFFALO



- Included in CITES Appendix III.
- Major threats: Loss of genetic diversity due to introgression with domestic & feral buffaloes and disease from domestic livestock.
- Hunted for food, sport, and handicrafts products.
- IUCN Status: Endangered

PYGMY HOG



- Now confined to a very few locations in and around Manas National Park.
- Most habitat has been lost to settlements and agriculture following the rapid expansion of the human population.
- IUCN Status: Critically Endangered

ARUNDHATI SWARNA YOJANA



- Each beneficiary bride will get Rs. 30,000 to buy gold during her marriage.
- **Aim:** to strengthen women empowerment and reduce child marriage.
- **Eligibility:** Bride should have minimum education of 10th standard, not required for tribes and workers of tea gardens.
- **Condition:** Register marriage under the Special Marriage (Assam) Rules, 1954.

PRANAM BILL



- The bill is first of its kind in the country.
- PRANAM Commission looks after the issues related to the Parents Responsibility and Norms for Accountability and Monitoring (PRANAM) Bill.
- If the PRANAM Commission gets a complaint that parents or differently abled siblings of a state government employee is being ignored, then 10 or 15% of the employee's salary will be deducted by the government and paid to the parents or differently abled siblings.

BEST PRACTICES IN BUDGET FORMULATION



- Survey conducted by Transparency International.
- The survey was based on 4 parameters:
 - ✓ public disclosure,
 - ✓ budgetary process,
 - ✓ post-budget fiscal management and
 - ✓ efforts to make the budget more transparent and citizen-friendly.
- Assam was followed by Andhra Pradesh and Odisha in the ranking of best practices followed by states in the Budget formulation.
- The report states that **Assam is the only state** out of the 29 states and 2 UTs, which has published a Citizens' Budget in the public domain.
- Also, the government of Assam is the only government that has conducted budget awareness campaigns across 17 districts.

ASSAM WITCH HUNTING (PROHIBITION, PREVENTION AND PROTECTION) ACT, 2015



- Prepared in lines with spirit of universal declaration of human rights, crimes in witch hunting cases cause gross violation of basic human rights.

Features of the Bill:

- Aims to eliminate superstition from society by making such offences under it as non-bailable, non-compoundable and cognizable.
- It prohibit any person from calling, identifying or defaming anyone as witch by words, signs, conducts or indications.
- Imposes up to 7 years of jail and fine up to Rs. 5 lakh.
- It also proposes sentence of 3 years imprisonment if anybody blames a person for natural disasters in a particular locality such as floods, droughts, illness or any death.
- Cases and offences registered under this law will undergo trial in Special courts which will be set up in consultation with the high court.

SPRING FESTIVAL



- Held at Manas National Park.
- Organized by Indian Weavers' Association and Swankar Mithinga Onsai Afat, an association of reformed poachers in Manas (now engaged in wildlife conservation and preservation).
- Aim: To promote local food and culture of fringe villagers.
- It also attempted to create model of alternative livelihood through food, handloom and culture.

BARAK FESTIVAL



- First ever Namami Barak festival was held at Silchar in Assam.
- Three day river festival aimed to pay tribute to River Barak and to showcase of Barak's potential & possibilities to emerge as hub of trade and commerce.
- Showcased cultural heritage of valley together with its cuisine, fauna and flora, socio-economic and civic splendor before global audience.

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